



GMAT Club Verbal Flashcards

Critical Reasoning • Reading Comprehension

September 17, 2025

CR • Basic Deconstruction



Q. List the 5-step process to tackle CR:
categorize, read, pre-think, eliminate, and check for sense.

CR • Basic Deconstruction



A.

- 1) Read the question stem and identify the type.
- 2) Read the stimulus; find premise(s) and conclusion.
- 3) Focus on the conclusion; pre-think possible answers.
- 4) Use POE to remove wrong answers; do not force a fit.
- 5) Ensure the final choice makes sense in context.

CR • Main Parts



Q. Define Premise, Conclusion, and Assumption.

Give 2 common conclusion indicators.

CR • Main Parts



Premise: evidence supporting the argument. **Conclusion:** the claim the author wants you to accept.

Assumption: an unstated link the argument relies on.

Conclusion indicators: thus, therefore, hence, so, consequently, it follows that.

CR • Question Families



Q. What are the three families of CR questions and two examples in each?

CR • Question Families



A. Type I (Assume stimulus true → pick something proven):
Inference, Main Point/Must Be True.

Type II (Assume choice true → it helps):
Strengthen, Assumption (supporter/defender).

Type III (Assume choice true → it hurts): Weaken, Find the Flaw/Counter.

CR • Common Traps



Q. Name four frequent wrong-answer patterns you should eliminate quickly.

CR • Common Traps



A. Opposite answers;
Shell game (sound-alike shift);
Out of Scope/Irrelevant;
Tone/strength mismatch.

CR • Assumption Negation



Q. How does the Assumption Negation technique work, and when is it most useful?

CR • Assumption Negation



A. For necessary assumptions, negate the contender: if the negation wrecks the argument, the original is required. Use when two–three contenders remain.

CR • Must Be True / Main Point



Q. To be considered for this year's merit scholarship award, students need perfect attendance and a 4.0 GPA. Alex is the only person in the class who has a 4.0 but he has had 5 absences. Which conclusion is most supported?

- A) No student at this school has perfect attendance for the year
- B) Some students without a 4.0 also did not have perfect attendance
- C) Alex is the only student who could be considered for the award
- D) No student at this school qualifies for the award this year
- E) Many students have perfect attendance but never 4.0 GPAs

CR • Must Be True / Main Point



A. Correct: D. Both conditions are required. Alex lacks perfect attendance; no one else has a 4.0. Therefore nobody qualifies.

CR • Weaken



Q. A store stocks only the top 10 cell-phone brands. To increase sales, it plans to increase inventory to the top 50. Which, if true, points out a major flaw?

- A) Top five phones have similar capabilities
- B) The top 8 brands account for almost all cell phones sold
- C) Users want to try lesser-known brands for added value
- D) Less popular brands provide little profit to the store
- E) Leading brands are losing sales to cheaper, less popular brands

CR • Weaken



A. Correct: B. If the top 8 brands account for nearly all sales, expanding to 50 brands won't meaningfully increase sales.

CR • Strengthen



Q. Several companies withdrew ads from Magazine A after it shifted from family values to sex/violence. This shows ad agencies act from moral propriety. Which most strengthens?

- A) Advertisers regularly review ad placements
- B) It is rare for several advertisers to pull out simultaneously
- C) Advertisers said clients would lose revenue after withdrawal
- D) Advertisers placed new ads with publications emphasizing family values
- E) A reader survey shows Magazine A's content declined in quality

CR • Strengthen



A. Correct: D. Moving the ads to a family-values outlet ties the withdrawals to moral concerns, not mere strategy.

CR • Flaw / Assumption



Q. Bacteria could have developed on Mars and arrived on Earth via meteorite. But since no two Earth strains differ enough to be from different planets, any Martian bacteria must have died out. The argument is vulnerable because it fails to consider whether...

- A) bacteria actually developed on Mars
- B) Martian bacteria were likely transported to Earth
- C) there were other means besides meteorites to bring bacteria
- D) all current Earth bacteria could have arisen from transported Martian bacteria
- E) some Earth-origin strains later died out

CR • Flaw / Assumption



A. Correct: D. If all current bacteria descended from transported Martian bacteria, large protein differences would not be expected.

CR • Resolve the Paradox



Q. Government pays farmers the amount by which market price falls short of a target. In 1983, a severe drought caused farm-program payments to drop by \$10B. Which best explains the reduction?

- A) Target price was raised before 1983
- B) U.S. exported less food in 1983 than the prior year
- C) Drought caused smaller harvests and higher market prices for 1983 crops
- D) Farmers planned smaller crops in 1984
- E) Retail food prices did not increase significantly between 1982 and 1983

CR • Resolve the Paradox



A. Correct: C. Higher market prices reduce Target – Market, so payments fall despite drought.

CR • Reasoning / Parallel



Q. Shakespeare was the world's greatest playwright, so he wrote the world's greatest plays; and because he wrote the greatest plays, he is the greatest playwright. Which matches this reasoning?

- A) Opinion-based comparison of poets
- B) No miscarriages of justice because prisoners are guilty; otherwise they wouldn't be imprisoned
- C) Blood test rules out disease X
- D) Conflicting accusations between suspects
- E) Tartar sauce example about spiciness

CR • Reasoning / Parallel



A. Correct: B. Both are circular: the claim proves the evidence and the evidence proves the claim.

CR • Assumption (Necessary)



Q. Survey: 80% of severely injured drivers/front-seat passengers were not wearing seat belts. Conclusion: wearing seat belts greatly reduces risk of severe injury. The conclusion is not properly drawn unless:

- A) More than 20% of drivers/passengers in the survey were wearing seat belts at the time
- B) Considerably more than 20% of drivers/passengers always wear seat belts in the county
- C) More drivers/front-seat passengers than rear-seat passengers were severely injured
- D) More than half of the drivers/front-seat passengers in the survey were not wearing seat belts at the time
- E) Most auto accidents reported do not involve any serious injury

CR • Assumption (Necessary)



A. Correct: B. We need a baseline showing many people usually wear belts; otherwise the 80% figure lacks comparative force.

RC • The Big Picture



Q. What are the four questions you should answer as you read any passage?

RC • The Big Picture



A.

Why? (Main Point)

How? (Organization/structure)

What? (Key ideas of each paragraph)

What Tone? (Author's attitude). Read general→specific; adjust strategy, not speed.

RC • Global vs Local



Q. Name three Global question types and four Local question types you will see on GMAT RC.

RC • Global vs Local



Global:

Main Point/Primary Purpose; Passage Organization; Author's Perspective/Tone.

Local:

Specific Reference line/paragraph; Function (what a part does); Strengthen/Weaken; Parallel Reasoning.

RC • New vs Existing Ideas



Q. List some signal words for new vs continuing ideas.

RC • New vs Existing Ideas



A.

Continuations:

furthermore, for instance, for example, additionally, similarly, indeed, in fact.

New/contrast:

however, but, nevertheless, yet, in contrast, although, still.

RC • Common Indicators



Q. Give four high-value indicators to mark/annotate while reading.

RC • Common Indicators



A. Main point claims; lists/enumerations; references with authority (track who s

RC • Specific Reference



Q. How do you approach line/paragraph reference questions quickly?

RC • Specific Reference



A. Go back to the cited lines, expand a few lines above/below, restate in your own words.

RC • Function Questions



Q. What does a Function question ask, and how do you answer it?

RC • Function Questions



A. It asks what a part of the passage is doing. Identify the local role (introduce, e